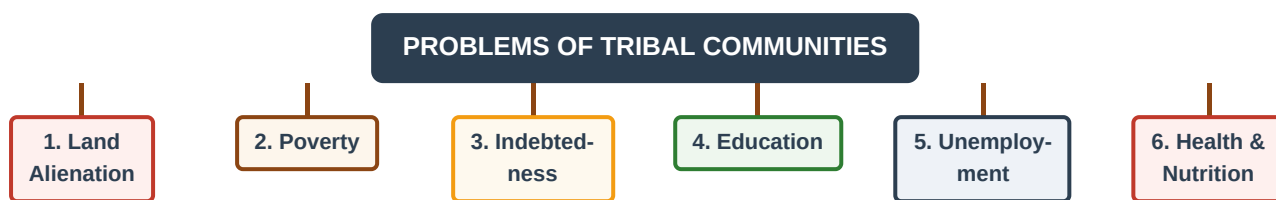


TRIBAL INDIA — Part 2: Problems of Tribal Communities

Sarrthi IAS | Anthropology Optional Paper 2 (Unit 6.2) | UPSC CSE 2026



Marginalisation Framework: Exploitation (missionaries, moneylenders, contractors) + Restrictive forest policies + Displacement + Primitive agriculture + Extravagant social spending + Geographical isolation → Land alienation, poverty, indebtedness, low literacy, unemployment, health crises, Naxalism, ethnic conflict

1. LAND ALIENATION

- **Definition:** Process by which tribals lose ownership/access to traditional land
- Land = basis of **social identity, cultural continuity, and ecological survival**
- Forces tribals into wage labour or migration; leads to economic insecurity, cultural erosion, social disintegration

L.P. Vidyarthi: "Land alienation is the root cause of all forms of tribal unrest and discontent"

Dhebar Commission: "The loss of land is the loss of livelihood, dignity, and identity"

Causes of Land Alienation

Cause	Detail
Chronic cash shortage	Low income → borrow at exploitative terms (e.g., Korwa tribe, M.P.)
Inadequate agricultural yield	Traditional tools, no irrigation, small/infertile holdings → subsistence-level output
Chronic indebtedness	Moneylenders take land as mortgage (Tharu & Bhoksa tribes, U.P. — post-Partition refugee exploitation)
Failed state credit	Complex formalities & delays in govt credit → tribals return to informal lenders
Mining & industry	261 Baiga families displaced by Vedanta BALCO; Niyamgiri Hills — Dongria Kondhs; Karanpura coalfield
Dams & infrastructure	Narmada Valley: 200,000 displaced; NBA protests (1985+)
National parks & reserves	Kanha (450 Baiga/Gond families), Kuno (80% Saharias BPL), Orang NP (2017)
Forest policies	Indian Forest Act 1927 — removed community ownership, criminalised livelihood
Court machinery abuse	Moneylenders drag defaulting tribals to court; legal ignorance ensures land loss
Temptation & voluntary surrender	Lured into selling for short-term cash; landlords exploit illiteracy

Typologies of Land Alienation

- **Private transactions:** Mortgaging, sale, illegal sale, encroachments, loss before survey
- **Survey & settlements:** Cultivation land categorised as govt land; shifting cultivation as state-owned
- **Forest notification:** Encroachments not regularised; shifting cultivation areas as forests
- **Land acquisition & displacement:** Landlessness from development projects
- **Poor wasteland distribution:** Govt wastelands not allocated to tribals

Consequences

- Loss of livelihood — dispossession from forest and cultivable land
- Erosion of traditional institutions — collective systems like *Khuntkatti* (Mundas), *Bhuinhari* (Oraons) collapse
- Migration & urban drift — seasonal migration to Raipur, Ranchi, brick kilns
- Social stratification — new landlord tribals emerge; others become dependent labourers
- Conflict & unrest — mass protests (Sardar Sarovar, Tawa, Bargi dams)

B.K. Roy Burman: Class differentiation within the tribe after land alienation

Walter Fernandes: Links displacement to development-induced impoverishment

Impact on Tribal Women

- Women lose access to forest produce, firewood, fodder, shifting cultivation plots (their traditional domains)
- Baiga & Gond women (M.P.) — managed Bewar fields, now depend on daily wage labour
- Displacement negotiations with male heads — women left **without ownership or compensation**
- Polavaram Dam (A.P.) — female-headed households least compensated, most food insecure

Case Studies

Koraput District <i>Odisha</i> Tribal landholdings fell by 50%+ between 1970–1990 (Xaxa, 2001)	Narmada Valley Project <i>Gujarat/M.P./Maharashtra</i> 30 major + 135 medium + 3000 small dams; 200,000 displaced (majority Adivasi). NBA movement from 1985.
Kanha Tiger Reserve (2014) <i>Madhya Pradesh</i> ~450 Baiga & Gond families evicted. Asmita Kabra: 80% of Saharias BPL after Kuno relocation.	Karanpura Coalfield <i>Jharkhand (Hazaribagh, Ramgarh, Ranchi, Latehar, Chatra)</i> 83 coal blocks, 203 villages, 1,420 sq km, 425 sq km forest. Total acquisition >75,000 ha.
Polavaram Dam <i>Andhra Pradesh</i> Female-headed households least compensated & most food insecure.	Soliga Tribes (Co-existence Model) <i>Biligirirangana Hills, Karnataka</i> Allowed to stay → tiger population increased , proving co-existence works.

Protective Legislations & Remedial Measures

Law/Measure	Key Provision
Chotanagpur Tenancy Act (1908)	Restricts transfer of tribal land to non-tribals in Jharkhand
Santhal Pargana Tenancy Act (1949)	Prohibits land transfer even for public purposes
Forest Rights Act (2006)	Recognises individual & community rights to land & forest resources
LARR Act (2013)	Fair compensation & rehabilitation in land acquisition
Scheduled Areas Commission (1961)	Prohibition on all land transfers from tribals to non-tribals without DC permission

Way Forward

- Effective enforcement & participatory governance
- Recognition of community land rights under FRA
- Sustainable development integrating **tribal consent, compensation, and cultural continuity**

2. POVERTY

- Multi-dimensional & structural problem rooted in historical marginalisation, resource deprivation, exclusion
- Planning Commission: STs BPL (rural) declined from **62.3% (2004-05) to 45.3% (2011-12)**; urban 35.5% to 24.1% — yet **poorest among all social groups**
- Colonial forest/land policies + post-Independence industrialisation + Green Revolution bypassed subsistence tribal economy

 **D.N. Majumdar:** "Tribal poverty is not merely economic but an outcome of dislocation from the ecological niche and exploitation by the dominant society"

B.D. Sharma's Five Levels of Deprivation

#	Level	Example
1	Non-recognition of rights over resources	Loss of ancestral land during Narmada Dam without prior informed consent
2	Alienation of workers from means of production	Dispossession → bonded/daily wage labour in central India
3	Denial of due instalment of labour	Adivasi tea workers in Assam earn less than non-tribal workers
4	Bartering of liberty	Human trafficking & forced prostitution — tribal women/girls in Jharkhand, Odisha, Chhattisgarh
5	Psychological acceptance of deprivation	Continuous exploitation → loss of self-respect, fatalism, internalised poverty

 **B.D. Sharma:** "The tribal world is being impoverished in the name of development." / "Tribals are not poor by culture, but made poor by circumstance."

Additional Causes

Cause	Detail
Moneylenders & debt	Land mortgaged and lost to private lenders
Developmental displacement	Dams, mining, industrial projects displace lakhs
Systemic barriers	Discrimination, remoteness, lack of political voice, exclusion from skill programmes
Education & healthcare gaps	NFHS-5: high malnutrition & infant mortality; education gaps restrict employment
Weak scheme implementation	IRDP, NREP, MGNREGA, PDS, TSP fail to reach remote areas

Consequences

- **Chronic indebtedness** — Santhals mortgage land or sell forest produce cheaply
- **Dehumanising conditions** — 54% lack sanitation; 47% lack safe drinking water (NFHS-5)
- **Health deterioration** — IMR among STs 40% higher than national average (MoTA, 2021)
- **Loss of autonomy** — dependence on MGNREGA/PDS weakens traditional subsistence
- **Inter-generational deprivation** — poverty transmits via poor schooling & malnutrition (L.P. Vidyarthi, Ranchi studies)

Impact on Tribal Women

- Women: 12+ hr daily work (domestic + wage) — Santhal women (ICSSR study)
- Eat last and least — 60%+ anaemia among tribal females (NFHS-5)

Case Studies

Tharu & Bhoksa Tribes

Uttar Pradesh

Post-Partition Punjab refugee moneylenders exploited via fraudulent contracts

Baiga & Gond Tribes

Madhya Pradesh

Evictions from Kanha Tiger Reserve (2014) deepened poverty

Saharias

M.P. (Kuno relocation)

Asmita Kabra (2009): 80% BPL after losing MFP access post-displacement

Schemes & Interventions

Scheme	Key Detail
IRDП	Assisted 42% of tribal families up to Eighth Plan
Tribal Sub-Plan (1974-75)	Plan funds proportional to tribal population; area-based development
FRA 2006	Individual & community rights over forest land/produce
PESA Act 1996	Self-governance in Scheduled Areas via Gram Sabhas
LARR Act 2013	Fair compensation and rehabilitation
PM-JANMAN (2024)	Focus on PVTGs
EMRS	Quality education in tribal areas
TRIFED & Van Dhan Yojana	Value addition & marketing of forest produce

Way Forward

- Strengthen FRA, PESA, land-tenancy law implementation
- Education in tribal languages with contextual curricula
- Community-based forest management & eco-tourism
- Livelihood diversification through skill development
- Participatory planning respecting tribal consent in all projects

3. INDEBTEDNESS

- One of the oldest and most persistent socio-economic problems
- Traditional tribal societies based on **subsistence economies and reciprocity**
- Colonial & post-colonial contact with money economy introduced cash dependency, credit, and exploitation
- Widespread except in a few North-Eastern areas (historically protected from middlemen)

 **Christoph von Furer-Haimendorf:** "The shift from a barter-based economy to a monetised one exposed tribals to exploitation by moneylenders, contractors, and traders"

 **Rangarajan:** About **36% of ST farmer households** are indebted, mostly to non-institutional sources

 **Tripathi:** Tribes once shared a "harmonious and symbiotic relationship with forests"

Causes

Cause	Detail
Loss of forest rights	Indian Forest Act 1927 displaced tribals from livelihood base
Poor cultivation methods	Primitive tools, low productivity, no irrigation → no surplus
Ignorance & market exploitation	Illiteracy & unfamiliarity with commerce → prey to cunning merchants
Extravagant ceremonial spending	Lavish marriage & festivals → borrowing at high interest for social prestige
Role of moneylenders	Formal credit fails (bureaucracy); moneylender offers immediate cash at exorbitant rates

Consequences

- **Loss of freedom:** Borrower & family become bonded labourers (e.g., Sahariya tribe, *Hali* system)
- **Land alienation:** Land seized by creditors → chronic landlessness
- **Sale of girls & trafficking:** Debt repayment via sale of daughters (Bedia community)
- **Health impacts:** STDs — 36.5% prevalence among tribal villagers (V.G. Rao, Jabalpur)
- **Hereditary debt & bonded labour:** *Goti* system binds families for generations (Juang PVTGs, Odisha)

 **V.G. Rao:** 36.5% STD prevalence among tribal villagers (Jabalpur study)

 **Anumeha Yadav:** *Goti* bonded labour persists in Odisha despite central and state laws

Impact on Tribal Women

- Pushed into **bonded labour or sexual exploitation** when families fall into debt
- Ho & Munda women (Jharkhand/Odisha) exploited as domestic servants through networks
- Indebtedness breaks kinship support → vulnerable to **trafficking and migration-related abuse**

Case Studies

Sahariyas — Hali System

Baran, Rajasthan

Bonded labour for landlords despite Bonded Labour Abolition Act, 1976. Tricked into loans at exorbitant interest.

Juang (PVTG) — Goti System

Odisha

Families forced to labour in debt repayment despite Orissa Debt Bondage Act, 1948.

Bedia Community

Central India

Women pushed into prostitution as debt-repayment practice.

Legislations & Remedial Measures

Law/Initiative	Key Feature
AP Scheduled Areas Moneylenders Regulation, 1963	Regulates credit transactions in tribal areas
Mysore Pawnbrokers Act, 1961	Controls lending practices & interest rates
Assam Money Lending Regulation, 1968	Restricts exploitative lending in tribal regions
Fifth Schedule of Constitution	Empowers states to regulate moneylending & land transfers in Scheduled Areas
M.P. (2019) — Tribal Moneylender Act	All loans from unlicensed moneylenders to STs waived
NSTFDC	PSU under MoTA; concessional loans for income generation
AMSY (Adivasi Mahila Sashaktikaran Yojana)	Loan up to 90% for projects ≤ ₹2 lakh at 4% p.a.
MCF (Micro Credit for SHGs)	Up to ₹50,000/member; max ₹5 lakh/SHG

Way Forward

- Empower tribals through **secure land rights, community banking, financial literacy**
- Strengthen implementation of existing protective laws
- Indebtedness is both a **cause and consequence** of underdevelopment — holistic approach needed

4. TRIBAL EDUCATION

- Census 2011: ST literacy = **59%** vs. 73% national average (14-point gap)
- ST male literacy: 68.5%, female: below 50%

 **Verrier Elwin:** "Education for tribals must be of the forest and not against the forest" / "Let us teach the tribe not to despise his culture, but to enrich it through knowledge"

Key Statistics

Indicator	Value
ST Literacy (2001 → 2011)	47.1% → 59%
ST Male Literacy	68.5%
ST Female Literacy	Below 50%
Highest ST Literacy	Mizoram (91.6%)
Lowest ST Literacy	Andhra Pradesh (49.2%)
States with gap >18 pts	Tamil Nadu, Odisha, M.P., W. Bengal, Kerala

Constitutional Provisions

Article	Provision
Art. 46	Promote educational & economic interests of SCs, STs, weaker sections
Art. 29(1)	Right to conserve distinct language, script, and culture
Art. 15(4)	Special provisions for educational advancement of SCs/STs
Art. 275(1)	Grants-in-aid for tribal welfare including education
Art. 350A	Mother tongue instruction at primary stage for linguistic minorities

Causes of Educational Backwardness

Cause	Detail
Poor socio-economic conditions	Education = luxury; children in wage labour; girl child suffers from safety/domestic burden
Lack of infrastructure	Schools few, far; lack electricity, sanitation, teachers
Language barrier	Teaching in regional/national language, not mother tongue → high dropout; Art. 350A seldom implemented
Teacher challenges	Few trained/willing for remote areas; cultural insensitivity & absenteeism
Gender disparity	Female literacy lags by ~20%; early marriage, lack of girls' hostels, poor hygiene
Cultural disconnect	Schools alienate children from traditional occupations & values

Consequences

- **Low literacy & dropouts:** Linguistic gaps & poor infrastructure
- **Limited employability:** Lack of English/technical skills despite reservation benefits
- **Cultural alienation:** Curriculum alien to tribal worldview (e.g., Gonds, M.P.)
- **Gender disparity:** Female 49% vs. male 68%; Xaxa Committee (2014) — early marriage reduces girls' schooling
- **Leadership deficit:** Educated tribal elite serves self-interest (S.C. Dube, 1955)

Impact on Tribal Women

- Girls drop out due to distance, safety, early marriage
- A.P. PVTGs (Chenchu, Konda Reddi) — girls leave after Class V (no female teachers/hostels)

Schemes

Scheme	Key Feature
EMRS (Eklatya Model Residential Schools)	Quality education on Navodaya school lines
Ashram Schools	Residential schools in remote tribal areas
Pre-Matric & Post-Matric Scholarships	Financial aid for ST students
TSP & Art. 275(1) Grants	Earmarked funding for educational infrastructure
NEP 2020	Bilingual education; inclusion of local knowledge systems
Adivasi Mahila Shikshan Kendra	Literacy centres for tribal women

Way Forward

- Expand EMRS; recruit local teachers; bilingual systems (TSR Subramanian Committee, NEP 2020)
- Kerala's "One Family, One Job" model for local employment
- Cultural sensitisation training for teachers; tribal history exhibitions in schools
- Protect students from abuse (Muzaffarpur case; Maharashtra — 29 tribal girls, 2011-16)
- Girls' schools/hostels in remote areas; bicycles (Bihar model); menstrual hygiene scheme
- Awareness camps, street dramas, community mobilisation
- Periodic reviews by District Collectors/Tribal Welfare Officers

5. UNEMPLOYMENT & UNDEREMPLOYMENT

- Structural issues: loss of traditional livelihood, lack of education, displacement, marginalisation
- Nearly **75% of tribals** in agriculture (largely subsistence-based)

 **Richard Mahapatra:** "Tribals are quitting farming fast, and every second household now survives on manual labour in an informal economy"

Occupational Profile

Category	Examples
Agriculture & allied (75%)	Majority of tribals
Pastoral & herding	Todas (Nilgiris), Bhotias, Gaddis, Bakarwals
Artisans & blacksmiths	Asur & Agaria (Jharkhand, M.P., Bihar)
Foragers	Chenchu, Paniya, Onge
Industrial & migrant labourers	Construction, domestic work, mining

NSSO Data (2011-12)

Category	Male	Female
Urban ST Unemployment	3.4% (from 2.9%)	4.8% (from 3.4%)
Rural ST Unemployment	1.3% (from 1.1%)	1.1% (from 0.4%)
Rural ST Employment Breakdown (Male): Self-employed 56.4% Casual labour 38.8% Regular/salaried 4.8%		

Causes

Cause	Detail
Loss of traditional livelihood	Forest laws & industrial expansion; sharp decline in forest-based livelihoods (Tribal Health Report)
Displacement & migration	Mining/development → forced migration as contract/domestic labourers
Educational deprivation	Lack of quality schooling, vocational training, career counselling
Infrastructural deficit	Poor roads, electricity, internet in tribal regions
Discrimination	Stereotypes & social exclusion → wage discrimination, fewer jobs
Agricultural seasonality	Rain-fed agriculture causes seasonal unemployment
Vacant reserved posts	112th Parliamentary Committee (2023): 1,199/3,097 ST posts vacant in 45 central universities; 3,000+ in ministries
Frustration & extremism	Lack of economic opportunity → some youth join extremist movements

 **Saiyed Zegham Murtaza:** "These figures betray an extreme disregard of the reservation norms"

 **N.C. Saxena:** Agriculture & forest work limited to 4-5 months/year — seasonal underemployment

Consequences

- **Seasonal underemployment:** Work only 4-5 months; rest in casual labour
- **Distress migration:** Jharkhand/Odisha to brick kilns in A.P., factories in Surat/Mumbai — no social security
- **Skill mismatch:** Less than **2% of tribal youth formally trained** (National Skill Development Report, 2018)
- **Rise in bonded labour:** Persistent poverty/debt in M.P. & Rajasthan (ILO, 2016)
- **Psychological stress:** Joblessness fuels frustration, alcoholism, susceptibility to extremism

 **Bhatia:** Studies in Bastar link unemployment with Naxal recruitment

Impact on Tribal Women

- Bastar: 70%+ employed tribal women work as seasonal agricultural labourers under MGNREGA, earning less than men
- Forest/agriculture job decline → women migrate as domestic workers/brick kiln labourers
- Ranchi & Sundargarh: rising female migration to Delhi/Mumbai → loss of community support

MGNREGA & Tribal Participation

ST participation: peaked at **36%** (Year 1) → dropped to **16%** (2013-14) → stabilised **17-20%**. Tribals = 20% of total MGNREGA workers (2x their population share). — Adivasi Adhikar Rashtriya Manch (2023)

Schemes & Measures

Scheme/Initiative	Key Feature
MGNREGA	STs = 20% of total workers; key rural employment
JRY (Jawahar Rozgar Yojana)	Merged from NREP + RLEGP
NSTFDC	Concessional loans; promotes entrepreneurship
VTCs (Vocational Training Centres)	Handicrafts, tailoring, carpentry, trades
Career & Higher Education Scheme (2018-19)	Counselling, scholarships, placement support for ST students
EMRS	Quality education & employability skills
India's First Tribal Employment Exchange	Trivandrum (2018): career counselling, job linkage

Way Forward

- Tribal Skill Development Centres: local crafts, agro-processing, tourism, renewable energy
- Forest-based industries: bamboo, honey, herbal cooperatives; Public-Tribal Partnerships
- Strengthen MGNREGA: prioritise tribal regions, timely wages, social audits
- Fill backlog of ST-reserved posts; regular audits of ministries/universities
- Support tribal start-ups under Start-Up India + NSTFDC funding
- Workplace diversity campaigns; enforce equal pay

6. HEALTH & NUTRITION

- STs = 8.6% of population but health indicators **10-25% lower** than non-tribal
- Disproportionate burden of disease, malnutrition, and mortality

 **Abhay Bang Committee (2018):** "Tribal India faces a **triple burden** of communicable diseases, non-communicable diseases, and mental health problems"

Key Health Statistics

Indicator	Tribal	General	Source
Life Expectancy	63.9 yrs	67 yrs	Lancet
IMR (2005-06 → 2019-21)	62.1% → 41.6%	—	SRS/NFHS
Under-5 Stunting	44%	38%	NFHS-4
Underweight Children	45%	36%	NFHS-4
Wasting	27%	21%	NFHS-4
Adolescent Girls (BMI <18.5)	~50%	—	NFHS-4

Disease Burden

Disease	Tribal Data
Malaria	30% of all cases, 60% of <i>P. falciparum</i> , 50% of deaths (Bang Committee)
Tuberculosis	703/100,000 vs. 256 nationally (ICMR, 2021)
NCDs	66% of tribal deaths due to NCDs — CVD, diabetes, cancer, respiratory (ICMR)

Triple Burden of Diseases

Category	Key Diseases
Communicable	Malaria, TB, leprosy, diarrhoea, respiratory infections
Non-Communicable	Diabetes, hypertension, cancer, chronic respiratory illness
Mental Health & Substance Abuse	Displacement & cultural erosion → stress, alcoholism, rising suicide

Major Causes

Cause	Detail
Lack of awareness & mistrust	Illness attributed to supernatural causes; reliance on <i>ojhas</i> , <i>baigas</i> , <i>deotas</i> ; low vaccine acceptance
Unhygienic practices	Open defecation, unclean childbirth, unsafe drinking water
Poor health infrastructure	27-40% shortfall in PHCs/Sub-centres/CHCs; 33% doctor shortage
Financial constraints	TSP allocations often diverted or underutilised
Lack of micro-level data	Ignores tribe-specific vulnerabilities (sickle-cell, goitre)
Malnutrition & food insecurity	Loss of forest food → protein & micronutrient deficiency

Consequences

- **High mortality:** Life expectancy 5-6 yrs lower; malaria, sickle cell, fluorosis (ICMR, 2022)
- **Child malnutrition:** 45% stunted, 27% wasted (NFHS-5); worst in M.P., Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand
- **Maternal health:** 59% ST women anaemic; low institutional deliveries
- **Reduced productivity:** Malnourishment weakens agricultural/forest work capacity
- **Decline of traditional medicine:** Indigenous healers sidelined by public health systems

 **P.C. Joshi:** Integration of ethnomedicine with PHCs could improve health outcomes

Impact on Tribal Women

- Maternal mortality among ST women: **167 per lakh live births** (higher than national avg, NFHS-5)
- Dahanu (Maharashtra): 1 in 3 pregnancies anaemic/underweight
- Cultural barriers keep women from antenatal care/contraception
- Santhal & Bhil women: home births with untrained midwives → infection & complications

Case Studies

Keonjhar Paradox

Keonjhar District, Odisha

26% of India's iron ore. Revenue >₹15,000 cr (DMF + OMBADC). Yet: **worst child/maternal health in Odisha**. 74.7% pregnant women anaemic (vs. 61.8% state avg). Highest stunted/wasted/underweight children. Village Emiri: women travel 20+ km for delivery. **"Paradox of prosperity without well-being."**

Gadchiroli Model

Gadchiroli, Maharashtra

Dr. Abhay & Rani Bang's **SEARCH initiative** — reduced neonatal mortality by training village health workers for home-based newborn care. Power of **community participation, local training, traditional integration**.

Schemes & Initiatives

Category	Scheme	Key Feature
Policy	NHM (National Health Mission)	Tribal sub-plans; ASHA workers for last-mile delivery
	Abhay Bang Committee (2018)	Comprehensive roadmap; decentralised planning
	SWASTHYA Portal	Digital repository for tribal health data
	E-newsletter ALEKH	Health & nutrition awareness dissemination
Disease-specific	Aashwasan Campaign (2022)	TB awareness in 177 tribal districts; 10M people screened
	Malaria Elimination Programme (2030)	Focus on high P. falciparum tribal districts
Nutrition	ICDS	Supplementary nutrition for children & lactating mothers
	Poshan Abhiyaan	Target: reduce stunting, underweight, anaemia
	Mid-Day Meal Scheme	School attendance + child nutrition
Infrastructure	Tribal Health Centres & Mobile Medical Units	Remote area coverage; ASHAs/ANMs from tribal communities

Way Forward

- Integrate AYUSH + Allopathy; recognise traditional healers as intermediaries
- Health literacy via folk media, street plays, storytelling in tribal languages
- Fill doctor vacancies; incentivise service in tribal regions; build maternity hostels
- Restore forest rights for access to traditional foods (millets, tubers, wild fruits)
- Transparent TSP fund utilisation; create **National Tribal Health Mission (NTHM)**

 **Abhay Bang Committee (2019):** "Tribal health is a test of India's commitment to equity."

QUICK REVISION CHEAT SHEET

Table 1: Topic-wise Cheat Sheet

Topic	Key Scholars	Key Case Studies	Trigger Keywords
Land Alienation	L.P. Vidyarthi (root cause of unrest); Dhebar Commission (loss of dignity); B.K. Roy Burman (class differentiation); Walter Fernandes (development-induced); Xaxa (Koraput data); Asmita Kabra (Kuno)	Koraput (50% loss); Narmada (200K displaced); Kanha (450 families); Karanpura (75K ha); Polavaram (women); Soliga (co-existence); Niyamgiri (Dongria Kondhs)	Khuntkatti, Bhuihari, Bewar, NBA, FRA 2006, LARR 2013, Chotanagpur Tenancy Act
Poverty	B.D. Sharma (5 levels, "poor by circumstance"); D.N. Majumdar (ecological niche); L.P. Vidyarthi (inter-generational); Asmita Kabra (Saharias)	Tharu & Bhoksa (U.P.); Baiga & Gond (Kanha); Saharias (Kuno); Adivasi tea workers (Assam)	62.3% → 45.3% BPL, 5 levels, IRDP, TSP, trafficking, bonded labour
Indebtedness	Furer-Haimendorf (barter to monetised); Rangarajan (36% indebted); Tripathi (forest harmony); V.G. Rao (STDs); Anumeha Yadav (Goti)	Sahariyas/Hali (Rajasthan); Juang/Goti (Odisha); Bedia (prostitution); Ho & Munda women (Jharkhand)	Hali system, Goti, moneylender, bonded labour, NSTFDC, AMSY, Fifth Schedule
Education	Verrier Elwin (of the forest); S.C. Dube (tribal elite); Xaxa Committee (girls' schooling)	Mizoram 91.6% vs A.P. 49.2%; Chenchu/Konda Reddi PVTGs; Muzaffarpur; Maharashtra abuse case	59% vs 73%, Art. 46/350A, EMRS, NEP 2020, bilingual, dropout, mother tongue
Unemployment	Richard Mahapatra (quitting farming); N.C. Saxena (seasonal); Saiyed Zegham Murtaza (reservation disregard); Bhatia (Naxal recruitment)	75% in agriculture; 1,199 vacant ST posts; Bastar women (MGNREGA); Trivandrum Employment Exchange	MGNREGA (36% → 17-20%), NSSO, 2% trained, casual labour, distress migration
Health & Nutrition	Abhay Bang Committee (triple burden, equity test); P.C. Joshi (ethnomedicine); V.G. Rao (STD prevalence)	Keonjhar Paradox (₹15K cr but worst health); Gadchiroli Model (SEARCH); Dahanu (1/3 pregnancies anaemic)	63.9 yrs life expectancy, malaria 30%/60%, TB 703/100K, triple burden, NTHM, SWASTHYA

Table 2: Master Schemes Table

Scheme	Year	Problem Addressed	Key Feature
Chotanagpur Tenancy Act	1908	Land Alienation	Restricts tribal land transfer to non-tribals (Jharkhand)
Indian Forest Act	1927	Land/Indebtedness	Removed community ownership — negative impact
Santhal Pargana Tenancy Act	1949	Land Alienation	Prohibits land transfer even for public purposes
Mysore Pawnbrokers Act	1961	Indebtedness	Controls lending practices & interest rates
AP Scheduled Areas Moneylenders Regulation	1963	Indebtedness	Regulates credit in tribal areas
Assam Money Lending Regulation	1968	Indebtedness	Restricts exploitative lending
Tribal Sub-Plan (TSP)	1974-75	Poverty	Plan funds proportional to tribal population
ICDS	1975	Health	Supplementary nutrition for children & mothers
Bonded Labour Abolition Act	1976	Indebtedness	Abolishes bonded labour (still violated)
IRDP	1978	Poverty	Integrated rural development; 42% tribal families assisted
TRIFED	1987	Poverty	Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation
PESA Act	1996	Poverty/Land	Self-governance via Gram Sabhas in Scheduled Areas
MGNREGA	2005	Unemployment	STs = 20% of total workers; rural employment guarantee
NHM	2005	Health	Tribal sub-plans; ASHA workers
FRA	2006	Land/Poverty	Individual & community forest rights
MLE Programme	2006	Education	Multilingual education for tribal children (Odisha)
LARR Act	2013	Land Alienation	Fair compensation & rehabilitation
Poshan Abhiyaan	2018	Health	Reduce stunting, underweight, anaemia
Abhay Bang Committee	2018	Health	Comprehensive roadmap; decentralised planning
Career & Higher Education Scheme	2018-19	Unemployment	Counselling, scholarships, placement for STs
Tribal Employment Exchange	2018	Unemployment	First of its kind — Trivandrum; career counselling
M.P. Moneylender Loan Waiver	2019	Indebtedness	All unlicensed moneylender loans to STs waived
NEP 2020	2020	Education	Bilingual education; local knowledge systems
Aashwasan Campaign	2022	Health	TB screening in 177 tribal districts; 10M screened
PM-JANMAN	2024	Poverty	Focus on PVTGs
Malaria Elimination Programme	2030	Health	Focus on high-burden tribal districts
EMRS	Ongoing	Education/Unemployment	Quality residential schooling for ST students
Ashram Schools	Ongoing	Education	Residential schools in remote areas
Pre/Post-Matric Scholarships	Ongoing	Education	Financial aid for ST students
Adivasi Mahila Shikshan Kendra	Ongoing	Education	Literacy centres for tribal women
NSTFDC	Ongoing	Indebtedness/Unemployment	Concessional loans for income generation
AMSY	Ongoing	Indebtedness	4% interest loans for ST women (up to ₹2 lakh)
MCF (Micro Credit SHGs)	Ongoing	Indebtedness	₹50K/member; ₹5 lakh/SHG
Van Dhan Yojana	Ongoing	Poverty	Value addition & marketing of MFP
SWASTHYA Portal	Ongoing	Health	Digital tribal health data repository
Mid-Day Meal Scheme	Ongoing	Health/Education	Nutrition + school attendance
JRY (Jawahar Rozgar Yojana)	Ongoing	Unemployment	Merged from NREP + RLEGP
VTCs	Ongoing	Unemployment	Handicrafts, tailoring, carpentry training

 = Handwritten annotation in class PDF | Source: Sarthi IAS Thor × Team Avengers Handout | Compiled for UPSC CSE 2026